Khadijah (RA)

Khadijah bint Khawaylid (RA): A Life of Faith, Sacrifice and Support

Khadijah bint Khawaylid (RA) was a woman of remarkable character and noble qualities. She was known for her faithfulness, integrity, truthfulness, modesty, good manners, generosity, wisdom, and understanding. She was the first person to have an abiding faith in the words of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and to accept Islam as her religion and way of life. She was also honoured when Allah sent greetings to her through Angel Jibril (AS).

Khadijah (RA) was born in Makkah and came from the Quraysh. She inherited a prosperous business from her father and became known for her ability to manage it successfully. She employed hardworking and honest people to conduct business on her behalf and sent caravans to places such as Syria. Her business was among the most prosperous in Makkah.

When Khadijah (RA) heard about the honesty and integrity of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, she offered him employment in her business. He accepted and travelled to Syria accompanied by her trusted slave, Maisarah. The journey was extremely profitable. During the trip, Maisarah witnessed the Prophet's ﷺ remarkable character, honesty, strength, and principled behaviour. When they returned, he reported what he had witnessed to Khadijah (RA), leaving her deeply impressed.

Khadijah (RA) eventually became interested in marrying Muhammad ﷺ. After considering the matter and consulting her cousin Waraqah bin Nawfal, she became stronger in her desire to marry him. Their marriage took place, and they were blessed with six children: two sons, Qasim and Abdullah, followed by four daughters, Zainab, Ruqayyah, Umm Kulthum, and Fatimah (RA).

When the Prophet ﷺ received his first revelation, Khadijah (RA) became his source of comfort and reassurance. He returned home sweating and shaking after his experience in the Cave of Hira. Khadijah (RA) comforted him and assured him that Allah would never disgrace him because of his truthfulness, kindness, generosity, and support for people in difficulty. She then took him to her cousin Waraqah bin Nawfal, who explained that the visitor was the Angel who had come to Musa (AS).

Khadijah (RA) also remained patient during the severe three-year boycott in Shi'ab Abi Talib. Although she had previously lived in comfort and wealth, she gave up those comforts and endured the hardships alongside the Prophet ﷺ and the Muslims. The book describes her as an ideal wife and mother and states that the Prophet ﷺ lived in her house, where he found peace and comfort.

Khadijah (RA) passed away three years before the Hijrah at the age of sixty-five, after having spent twenty-five years with the Prophet ﷺ and supporting the cause of Islam. Her death deeply saddened him. She had been his greatest supporter and protector among his family during some of the most difficult periods of his life.

Her honour is also reflected in the narration of Abu Hurairah (RA). Angel Jibril (AS) came to the Prophet ﷺ and said that Khadijah (RA) was coming with food. He instructed the Prophet ﷺ to give her greetings from Allah and from him and to give her the glad tidings of a palace made of *Qasab* in Paradise, where there would be neither noise nor toil.

Khadijah (RA)'s life, as presented in *Great Women of Islam*, reflects her remarkable faith, character, sacrifice, and unwavering support for the Prophet ﷺ and the cause of Islam.

References

- *Great Women of Islam: Who Were Given the Good News of Paradise* — Mahmood Ahmad Ghadanfar.
- **Chapter: Khadijah bint Khawaylid (RA)** — pp. 19–29.
- **Hadith:** Sahih Al-Bukhari — narration regarding the palace of Qasab in Paradise.

Umm Salamah (RA)

Umm Salamah (RA): A Life of Patience and Wisdom

Umm Salamah bint Abu Umayyah (RA) was a woman known for her patience, wisdom, faith, and courage. Her life was filled with difficult trials, yet she remained firm in her faith and continued to support Islam.

Umm Salamah (RA) and her husband, Abu Salamah (RA), were among the Muslims who migrated to Abyssinia because of persecution in Makkah. While there, they were blessed with children. Later, they returned to Makkah, but as the persecution of Muslims became severe, they decided to migrate to Al-Madinah.

Their journey was extremely difficult. Umm Salamah (RA) was separated from her husband and children and had to endure this painful separation for a long period. Eventually, her children were returned to her, and she set out for Al-Madinah, gaining courage and solace from the fact that she now had her children with her. On the journey, she was helped by ‘Uthman bin Talhah (RA), who escorted her safely.

After the death of Abu Salamah (RA), Umm Salamah (RA) remained patient and prayed to Allah for a better future. Later, the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ proposed marriage to her. She expressed her concerns about her age, her children, and her temperament. The Prophet ﷺ reassured her, and she became one of the **Mothers of the Believers**.

Umm Salamah (RA) was also known for her wisdom. One of the clearest examples was during the Treaty of Hudaibiyah. When the Companions hesitated to carry out the Prophet's ﷺ command after the treaty, Umm Salamah (RA) advised him to perform the sacrifice himself without speaking to them. When they saw him do so, they followed his example.

She was also a knowledgeable woman who narrated many sayings of the Prophet ﷺ and was consulted on matters of religion.

A Woman of Paradise

Umm Salamah (RA) participated in the **Rizwan pledge**, and the book mentions her deserving Paradise. The Prophet ﷺ said:

> **“Allah has commanded me to marry only with the women of Paradise.”**

Umm Salamah (RA) lived a life of patience, sacrifice, wisdom, and devotion. Her story reflects the strength of faith through difficult circumstances and her important role among the Mothers of the Believers.

References

- *Great Women of Islam: Who Were Given the Good News of Paradise* — Mahmood Ahmad Ghadanfar, **pp. 77–91**.
- **The Noble Quran:** Surah At-Taubah (9:102, 118) and Surah Al-Ahzab (33:33).
- **Hadith:** Reference to the Rizwan pledge and Paradise — p. 77.

Aisha (RA)

Aishah bint Abu Bakr (RA): A Woman of Knowledge and Wisdom

Aishah bint Abu Bakr (RA) was the beloved daughter of Abu Bakr Siddique (RA), one of the closest companions and associates of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. She held a distinguished position among the Mothers of the Believers and was known for her brilliant mind, remarkable memory, wisdom, and mastery of religious teachings.

The book mentions that Allah had chosen her as a wife for the Prophet ﷺ. Angel Jibril (AS) brought her portrait wrapped in green silk to the Prophet ﷺ in his dream and told him:

> **“She is your wife in this world and hereafter.”**

Aishah (RA) was known for her exceptional intelligence and memory. She became a source of many Ahadith because of her long association with the Prophet ﷺ. Her knowledge included matters of **Fiqh and Shari'ah**, and she was known for her wisdom in interpretation, mastery of the Prophet's ﷺ teachings, trustworthiness, and integrity.

The book also describes nine blessings that distinguished her from other women, except Maryam bint 'Imran (AS). Among them was that she was the daughter of Abu Bakr Siddique (RA), was born a Muslim and brought up in a pure environment, and spent her formative years with the Prophet ﷺ. Verses of the Noble Qur'an were also revealed declaring her innocence from wrongdoing.

Aishah (RA) had an extraordinary memory from an early age. Even as a young girl, she demonstrated intelligence and knowledge of religious and historical matters. The book mentions an incident from her childhood involving a winged horse, in which she immediately recalled that Prophet Sulayman (AS) had winged horses.

When she joined the household of the Prophet ﷺ in Al-Madinah, she lived in a very simple room near the Prophet's Mosque. There was no worldly wealth or luxury in her surroundings, but the book describes her home as being filled with spiritual treasures.

Aishah (RA) was also honoured during her lifetime with the glad tidings of Paradise. The Prophet ﷺ passed away while resting in her lap, and he was buried in her apartment, which became his final resting place.

Aishah (RA) remains one of the most remarkable personalities described in *Great Women of Islam*—a woman distinguished by knowledge, intelligence, wisdom, devotion, and her close association with the Prophet ﷺ.

References

- *Great Women of Islam: Who Were Given the Good News of Paradise* — Mahmood Ahmad Ghadanfar, **chapter on Aishah bint Abu Bakr (RA)**.

- **Hadith:** Narration of Aishah (RA) regarding the dream of the Prophet ﷺ — *Tirmidhi*, chapter of *Fadha'il*.

Fatima (RA)

Fatimah bint Muhammad (RA): The Beloved Daughter of the Prophet ﷺ

Fatimah (RA) was the youngest and most beloved daughter of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ and Khadijah (RA). Known as **az-Zahra** (“the radiant”), she grew up in an environment of deep faith. She endured the early hardships of Islam with patience and courage – from witnessing the first revelations to sharing the boycott of the Hashimites – and remained devoted to her father’s cause.

In Madinah, Fatimah (RA) married her cousin ʿAli ibn Abī Ṭālib (RA) in **Safar, 2 AH**. She became the mother of their children al-Ḥasan, al-Ḥusayn, Zaynab, and Umm Kulthūm. She was known for her piety, generosity, and strength of character. ʿAishah (RA) noted that Fatimah (RA) **“bore a remarkable resemblance to Allah’s Messenger ﷺ”** in speech and manner. Fatimah (RA) worked alongside ʿAli, tended to their home, and supported the Muslim community in Madinah.

The Prophet ﷺ held Fatimah (RA) in highest esteem. He once said, **“Fatimah is a part of me, and whoever angers her, angers me”** – a sign of how deeply he loved and protected her. He also gave her glad tidings of Paradise, telling her that she would be **“the leader of the women of Paradise”**. Fatimah (RA)’s life was marked by patience and devotion. She remained close to her father ﷺ through all trials, and the Prophet ﷺ was laid to rest in her lap.

Fatimah (RA) died only six months after her father ﷺ, remaining devoted to the faith and family of the Prophet until the end. Her example of sacrifice, faith, and family loyalty makes her one of the most revered women in Islam, and she is honored among the *Mothers of the Believers* and the leaders of the women of Paradise.

> **“Fatimah is a part of me, and whoever angers her, angers me.”** – Prophet Muhammad (Peace Be Upon Him)

References

- *Great Women of Islam — Who Were Given the Good News of Paradise* (Mahmood Ahmad Ghadanfar), Chapter **“Fatimah bint Muhammad (RA)”**, **pp. 145–159**.

Zaynab Bint Jahash (RA)

Zaynab bint Jahsh (RA): Worship Through Hard Work and Generosity

A Noble Lineage and Early Devotion

Zaynab was born in Makkah approximately thirty years before the Hijrah. She came from a highly distinguished family — her mother, Umaimah bint 'Abdul Muttalib, was the paternal aunt of the Prophet ﷺ. She was blessed with a refined literary intellect and was among the early converts to Islam, deeply influenced by the teachings of her brother, 'Abdullah bin Jahsh. Along with her family, she endured the severe persecution in Makkah and took part in the historic migrations to Abyssinia and Al-Madinah.

A Marriage Decreed in the Heavens

Zaynab's marriage to the Prophet ﷺ carries deep significance in Islamic history. She was first married to Zaid bin Harithah, the Prophet's ﷺ freed slave and adopted son, but the marriage ended in divorce due to differences in temperament and background. To break the pre-Islamic custom that equated adopted children with biological ones, Allah commanded the Prophet ﷺ to marry Zaynab. When the proposal reached her while she was kneading dough, she turned immediately to prayer for guidance — and while praying, verses of the Qur'an were revealed announcing that Allah Himself had performed their marriage in the Heavens. She was justly proud of this honor, often reminding the other wives that while their families had arranged their marriages, hers was decreed directly by Allah.

Earning with Her Hands to Give in Charity

The Prophet ﷺ once told the mothers of the believers: "Among you she would meet me first in the Hereafter whose hands would be long." The wives later understood this to be a description of generosity rather than literal hand length — and it was Zaynab who turned out to have the longest reach in charity, and who passed away first among them, becoming, as the Hadith describes, a guest of Paradise. She was skilled in cottage industries such as tanning leather and needlework, working not for personal gain but to earn an honest living she could distribute entirely to the poor, orphans, and widows of Al-Madinah — she gave charity often and generously.

Defending Others and Purifying the Heart

Zaynab had a deeply honest, straightforward character. Though competitive by nature, her heart was free of malice — during the false rumors spread about 'Aishah (RA), the Prophet ﷺ asked Zaynab for her opinion, and even though 'Aishah was her rival in the household, Zaynab immediately defended her innocence, declaring she had seen nothing but goodness and integrity in her. 'Aishah never forgot this act of justice and sisterhood. Zaynab had a quick temper but was equally quick to recognize her mistakes and seek forgiveness from others.

The Honey Incident and a Gentle Lesson

Zaynab's story is also connected to a special type of honey she received from a relative. The Prophet ﷺ enjoyed spending time in her apartment to enjoy this honey, which caused lighthearted jealousy among the other wives. They arranged to remark that they noticed a strange smell on his breath, causing him to vow never to eat honey again. Allah then

revealed verses in the Qur'an gently rebuking the Prophet ﷺ for forbidding himself something pure, establishing that his words and actions would always remain a clear law for the Ummah.

A Peaceful and Dignified Final Return

Zaynab set up a small, quiet area in her home as a private mosque, dedicating her days and nights to constant remembrance and prayer. She passed away during the caliphate of 'Umar Farooq (RA) at the age of fifty-three, the first of the Prophet's ﷺ wives to die after him. Knowing her end was near, she prepared her own burial shroud beforehand. When 'Umar led her funeral prayer and she was buried in Jannatul Baqi', the poor of Al-Madinah wept bitterly, knowing they had lost their greatest benefactress and protector.

What Can We Learn From Zaynab (RA)?

1. **Work is an act of worship** — earning an honest living to help those with less is among the highest forms of righteousness.
2. **Defend the innocence of others** — true character shows when you protect someone's honor, even a rival's.
3. **Turn to Allah first in decisions** — seeking guidance (Istikharah) before major life choices brings peace.
4. **Be quick to repent** — humility to apologize immediately is a hallmark of true faith.

References

Ghadanfar, M. A. *Great Women of Islam*. pp. 93–103.
The Noble Qur'an, Surah Al-Ahzab (33:36–37, 33:53); Surah At-Tahreem (66:1).
Sahih Al-Bukhari — narration on her generosity and "long hands."

Umm Habibah

Umm Habibah bint Abi Sufyan (RA): A Life of Steadfastness and Faith

Umm Habibah's real name was Ramlah. She was born into one of the most powerful and aristocratic families in Makkah — her father, Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb, was the chieftain of the Quraish and a formidable opponent of the early Muslims. Despite being raised in luxury and high status, Ramlah was highly intelligent, independent-minded, and among the very first to accept Islam alongside her first husband, 'Obaidullah bin Jahsh. Despite her father's fury, she refused to recant her faith.

The Migration to Abyssinia

As persecution in Makkah intensified, Ramlah and her husband joined the second group of Muslim emigrants to Abyssinia, where King Najashi (the Negus) offered them sanctuary. There she gave birth to a daughter, Habibah, and became known by her kunyah, Umm Habibah. She spent her days caring for her daughter and in prayer, finding companionship with other migrant women.

The Hardship of Her Husband's Apostasy

While in exile, Umm Habibah had a disturbing dream of her husband's face mutilated. Days later, 'Obaidullah renounced Islam and returned to Christianity, urging her to follow — she refused. He then fell into severe alcoholism and died from it, leaving her widowed and impoverished in a foreign land, "living from hand to mouth." Even so, she never wavered in her faith.

A Prophetic Marriage Decreed by Allah

Umm Habibah later had a comforting dream in which she was addressed as "Mother of the Believers." When the Prophet ﷺ learned of her steadfastness and hardship, he sent an emissary to King Najashi with a marriage proposal. Najashi personally arranged the wedding, paid a dowry of four hundred Dinars on the Prophet's ﷺ behalf, and hosted the celebration. Overjoyed, Umm Habibah gave away her jewelry in gratitude to the messenger, Abraha, who later revealed she had secretly embraced Islam. Najashi arranged for Umm Habibah and the other refugees to sail safely back to Al-Madinah. Even her father, Abu Sufyan, expressed pride in the marriage.

Firmness of Faith: The Mattress Incident

When the Quraish broke the Treaty of Hudaibiah, Abu Sufyan traveled to Al-Madinah and visited his daughter. As he moved to sit on the Prophet's ﷺ mattress, she rolled it up out of his way, telling him plainly that it belonged to a pure Prophet and no idol-worshipper could sit on it. Offended, he accused her of forgetting her manners; she explained that Islam had taught her a different standard of purity altogether.

Character and Scholarly Standing

Despite her firm stance against polytheism, Umm Habibah longed for her family's guidance, and was overjoyed when her father and brother Mu'awiyah accepted Islam at the Conquest of Makkah. She is ranked third among the Mothers of the Believers in Hadith narration, with sixty-five Ahadith attributed to her. Near the end of her life, she sent messages of apology to

'Aishah and Umm Salamah, seeking their forgiveness for any past disagreements — both were deeply moved.

Key Stories and Hadith

The Prophet ﷺ once told her and her brother Mu'awiyah he hoped they would all drink the "clean wine" of Paradise together. Three days after her father's death, she deliberately wore perfume to demonstrate the Prophet's ﷺ teaching that mourning should not exceed three days, except for a husband. She narrated well-known Hadith on using the miswak before prayer and on the reward of voluntary prayers around the noon prayer. When Caliph Uthman (RA) was martyred, her grief led her to pray for justice against his killer — a prayer the text says was answered.

References

Ghadanfar, M. A. *Great Women of Islam* (trans. J. M. Qawi). pp. 123–134.

The Noble Qur'an: Surah Al-Mumtahanah (60:7); Surah Al-Fajr (89:30).

Hadith collections cited: Sahih Al-Bukhari, Musnad Abu Ya'la, Musnad Ahmad, Abu Dawood, An-Nasai, At-Tirmithi, Ibn Majah.

Hafsah (RA)

Hafsah bint 'Umar (RA): The Guarded Secret and Reciter of the Qur'an

Hafsah bint 'Umar (RA) was a woman of outstanding intellect, literary skill, and deep spiritual devotion. As the daughter of 'Umar Farooq (RA), she was raised in a household of courage and integrity. She held a unique and respected position among the Mothers of the Believers, known both for her intense devotion to fasting and prayer, and for her deep study and preservation of the Noble Qur'an.

Early Life and Lineage

Hafsah was born in Makkah during the reconstruction of the Ka'bah, five years before the Prophet ﷺ received his first revelation. Her father, 'Umar bin Khattab, was a renowned warrior; her maternal uncle was 'Uthman bin Maz'oon, the first Sahabi buried in Jannatul Baqi'. She was raised in a deeply religious, intellectually stimulating environment and was one of the very few people of her era — a time of widespread illiteracy — to master reading and writing.

Her First Marriage and Double Migration

Hafsah was married to Khanees bin Hazafah Sehmi, who embraced Islam early under Abu Bakr's guidance and endured cruelty from the Quraish. He migrated first to Abyssinia, then, after growing homesick and returning to Makkah, migrated again — this time with Hafsah — to Al-Madinah. He fought at the Battle of Badr and was seriously wounded; Hafsah drew comfort from Surah Al-Anfal and nursed him with care, but he died of his injuries, leaving her a widow at twenty-one.

How Her Marriage to the Prophet ﷺ Came About

Grieved by his daughter's loneliness, 'Umar sought a righteous partner for her — first approaching 'Uthman bin 'Affan, who declined, then Abu Bakr, who fell silent. Upset, 'Umar brought his concern to the Prophet ﷺ, who comforted him, predicting that Hafsah would find a husband better than 'Uthman, and 'Uthman a wife better than Hafsah. Soon after, the Prophet ﷺ married his daughter Umm Kulthum to 'Uthman, then proposed to Hafsah himself. They wed in the third year after the Hijrah, before the Battle of Uhud, when she was about twenty-two. Abu Bakr later explained his earlier silence — he had known of the Prophet's ﷺ private intention and could not betray the confidence.

Her Role in Preserving the Qur'an

Hafsah's relationship with the Qur'an was defined by diligence and deep spiritual connection. As verses were revealed, she memorized them systematically, spending long hours studying and reflecting on their meanings. As a literate, learned reciter of the Qur'an, she played a crucial role in safeguarding the revelation during the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime.

Her Character and Personality

Hafsah had an inquisitive mind and a direct, honest character. She was never afraid to raise questions of Shari'ah with the Prophet ﷺ — once quoting Surah Maryam (19:71) on Hell when he remarked that all who pledged allegiance at Hudaybiyah would enter Paradise; he gently answered by quoting the following verse (19:72) on the God-fearing being saved. She

shared a close, sisterly bond with 'Aishah, including a lighthearted coordinated plan (with Saudah) around the honey the Prophet ﷺ enjoyed in Zainab's apartment, which led to the revelation of Surah At-Tahreem (66:1). When her father advised her, during a time of national prosperity, to live simply and never demand an increase in allowance, she promised she never would — and kept that promise until her death.

Other Significant Events and Her Peaceful Demise

The Prophet ﷺ once confided a secret to Hafsah with a warning not to share it, but she told 'Aishah — an event preserved in Surah At-Tahreem (66:3). In 9 AH, when a false rumor spread that the Prophet ﷺ had divorced all his wives (he was actually resting due to a leg injury), it was 'Umar who had the courage to ask him directly and announce the rumor was false. Hafsah passed away in 41 AH, during the month of her fast, at fifty-nine. Her funeral was attended by eminent scholars including Abu Hurairah and Abu Sa'eed Khudri, who carried her shroud to Jannatul Baqi'.

What Can We Learn From Hafsah (RA)?

1. **Commit to the Qur'an** — memorizing and reflecting on its meanings builds an unbreakable bond with Allah.
2. **Value literacy and knowledge** — education and practical skill enable a believer to serve their community.
3. **Turn grief into devotion** — prayer and meditation are the best path through personal loss.
4. **Be trustworthy in ease** — living simply, even amid abundance, is a sign of spiritual maturity.

References

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Mustadrak Al-Hakim (4/15) — on Angel Jibril's description of her.

Juwayriyah (RA)

Juwayriyah bint Hārith (RA): A Source of Blessing for Her People

A Woman Whose Freedom Became a Blessing

Juwayriyah bint Hārith (RA) was the daughter of Hārith bin Abi Dirār, the chief of Banu Mustaliq. She was born before the advent of Islam and raised in luxury as the daughter of a powerful chief. She was known for her intelligence, wisdom, mastery of language and literary style, qualities that were highly valued among the Arabs of her time.

She had been married to Musāfa' bin Safwān, one of the rising young men of Banu Khuzā'ah.

The Battle of Banu Mustaliq

The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ received information that Hārith bin Abi Dirār was preparing to attack the Muslims at Al-Madinah. After gathering information about the situation, the Muslim forces prepared for battle.

The Muslim army reached Al-Marīsā', an important strategic location because of its water supply. The Prophet ﷺ invited Banu Mustaliq to accept Islam, but they instead chose to fight.

The battle ended with the defeat of Banu Mustaliq. Ten people were killed and around seven hundred were captured. Among the captives were women, and Juwayriyah (RA) was among them. Her husband, Musāfa' bin Safwān, was also among those who were killed.

From Captivity to Freedom

After the battle, the captives were distributed according to the custom of that time. Juwayriyah (RA) was given to Thābit bin Qais Ansāri.

Because of her difficult circumstances, Juwayriyah (RA) went to the Prophet ﷺ and pleaded for help. She explained that she was the daughter of a chief and that she had now fallen into a helpless situation. The book describes her condition as being like a person who had fallen from a throne of gold into dust.

She had been given to Thābit bin Qais in exchange for a ransom, but she had no means of obtaining the required amount.

The Prophet ﷺ offered her an unexpected path to freedom. He asked whether she would like to live as a free woman and become part of his household if her ransom was paid. Juwayriyah (RA) accepted this proposal. She was freed, pledged allegiance to Islam and married the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ.

A Blessing for Her Entire Tribe

Juwayriyah's (RA) marriage had consequences far beyond her own life.

When the Muslims learned of her conversion and marriage to the Prophet ﷺ, they freed the slaves belonging to the tribe of Banu Mustaliq. Thus, Juwayriyah (RA) was not only freed from captivity herself, but her people also benefited from her becoming a member of the Prophet's household.

The book records that hundreds of families from her tribe were freed through this event. Because of this, Juwayriyah (RA) became a source of blessing for her people.

‘Aishah (RA) is quoted in the book as saying that she had not seen another woman who became a greater source of blessing for her people than Juwayriyah (RA).

Her Devotion to Worship

Juwayriyah (RA) is presented in the book as a woman deeply devoted to prayer and worship.

One day, when the Prophet ﷺ left his home, he found her absorbed in prayer and supplication. When he returned in the afternoon, he found her still in the same position.

The Prophet ﷺ then taught her a short remembrance of Allah which, according to the narration quoted in the book, carried greater reward than her prayers throughout the whole morning.

The remembrance taught to her praises Allah according to the number of His creation, the extent of His pleasure, the weight of His Throne and the extent of His Words.

The book also quotes narrations from Muslim and Abu Dawood concerning this incident.

Her Name Before Her Marriage

The book states that before her marriage to the Prophet ﷺ, her name was **Barah**. It explains that the Prophet ﷺ changed her name, as he also changed the names of some other women who had the same name.

The book further cites Imam Baihaqi, who relates a dream Juwayriyah (RA) had seen before the Prophet ﷺ arrived. She saw the moon coming towards her from the direction of Al-Madinah and falling into her lap. She disliked speaking about the dream, but after her

people were conquered and she became a prisoner, she hoped that the dream would be fulfilled. According to the account, the Prophet ﷺ then freed her and married her.

Her Later Life

The book records that some time after her marriage, her father and the men who had been freed on the occasion of her marriage came before the Prophet ﷺ and accepted Islam. In this way, the book describes Juwayriyah (RA) as being blessed with two great honours: her people were freed from slavery through her, and they later entered Islam.

The book also records that from the lands taken after the Battle of Khaybar, the Prophet ﷺ fixed a share for Juwayriyah (RA) consisting of **80 wasaq of dates and 20 wasaq of barley**.

After the Prophet ﷺ passed away, Abu Bakr Siddique (RA) fixed an equal amount for the Mothers of the Believers for their household expenses. ‘Umar ibn Khattab (RA) initially fixed a smaller amount for Juwayriyah (RA) and Safiyyah (RA), but when ‘Aishah (RA) pointed out that the Prophet ﷺ had treated his wives equally, ‘Umar (RA) changed his decision and gave them the same stipend as the others.

Her Death

According to the book, Juwayriyah (RA) died at the age of **sixty-five**, in **Rabi-ul-Awwal in the 50th year after Hijrah**, during the caliphate of Mu‘awiyah bin Abi Sufyan.

The governor of Al-Madinah, Marwan bin Hakam, led her funeral prayer, and she was buried in **Jannatul Baqi‘**.

The chapter concludes with the Qur'anic words:

> “O the one in (complete) rest and satisfaction! Come back to your Lord - well pleased and well pleasing.”

Sources

Great Women of Islam, chapter **“Juveriah bint Hārith”**, from the uploaded PDF. The PDF's table of contents lists the chapter as **“Juwayriyah bint Hārith”**.

Safiyyah (RA)

Safiyyah bint Huyayee (RA): A Noble, Patient and Kind-Hearted Woman

A Woman of Noble Character

Safiyyah bint Huyayee (RA) was the favourite daughter of Huyayee bin Akhtab, the chieftain of the tribe of Banu Nadhir. Her mother was Barah bint Shamwāl, the sister of Rafā'ah bin Shamwāl.

She was married first to Salām bin Mashkam, but the marriage ended because of incompatibility. Her second husband was Kanānah bin Rabī' bin Haqeeq, who was killed during the events of Khaybar. Safiyyah (RA) was subsequently taken as a prisoner of war.

She was a woman of noble birth and excellent qualities. She was described as **noble, God-fearing, intelligent, beautiful, patient, tolerant and dignified**.

A Strange Reaction From Her Father and Uncle

Before her marriage to the Prophet ﷺ, Safiyyah (RA) lived in Al-Madinah with her father and her paternal uncle, Abu Yāsir.

When the Prophet ﷺ migrated to Al-Madinah, her father and uncle went to see him. However, when they returned, Safiyyah (RA) noticed that both of them were deeply disappointed and disturbed.

Her uncle repeatedly asked her father whether this was really the same man they had recognised. Her father confirmed that it was. He was then asked what his sincere opinion of the Prophet ﷺ was, and he replied that he would always regard him as an enemy.

Safiyyah (RA) heard this conversation and was shocked by the malice and hostility expressed by her father and uncle.

The Events of Khaybar

Later, after the Treaty of Hudaybiyyah, the Jews of Khaybar began preparing to attack Al-Madinah because they believed that the Muslims had become weak.

When the Prophet ﷺ learned of their preparations, he travelled towards Khaybar with an army. The Muslim forces reached the area at night and camped outside the city.

The following morning, the people of Khaybar were surprised to find the Muslim army near them. After Fajr, the Prophet ﷺ ordered the Muslims to advance.

By the grace of Allah, the Muslims were victorious and the forts of Khaybar were taken.

Safiyyah's (RA) father, Huyayee bin Akhtab, had already been killed in the battle of Bani Quraidah, while her husband Kanānah bin Rabī'ah bin Haqeeq was captured and killed according to the account in the book. Safiyyah (RA) was then taken as a prisoner of war.

Freedom and Marriage

Dahyah Kalbi (RA) was given the opportunity to choose a slave girl, and he chose Safiyyah (RA).

One of the Companions suggested that the Prophet ﷺ should keep Safiyyah (RA), because she was the daughter of a leader and chieftain, and give another slave girl to Dahyah Kalbi (RA).

The Prophet ﷺ then freed Safiyyah (RA) and married her. The book states, quoting Hafiz Ibn Qayyim, that **her freedom was her dowry**.

On the return journey to Al-Madinah, Umm Salim Ansāriyah dressed Safiyyah (RA) in her bridal finery.

Her First Journey as a Wife of the Prophet ﷺ

Safiyyah (RA) travelled with the Prophet ﷺ from Khaybar to Al-Madinah.

She said she had never encountered anyone more refined and well-mannered than the Prophet ﷺ. She described him as always pleasant and behaving like a perfect gentleman.

When the people of Al-Madinah heard of the Prophet's ﷺ arrival, they came out to greet him and his victorious army.

The Mothers of the Believers were also waiting to meet him. When they learned that he had married Safiyyah (RA), Aishah (RA) experienced a feeling of feminine jealousy.

Later, Aishah (RA) visited Safiyyah (RA). When the Prophet ﷺ asked her opinion of Safiyyah, she replied negatively. The Prophet ﷺ reminded her that Safiyyah (RA) had accepted Islam and should not be referred to in a disparaging way because of her previous Jewish identity.

Safiyyah (RA) Among the Mothers of the Believers

After moving into her own place, Safiyyah (RA) showed a pleasant and friendly attitude towards the other Mothers of the Believers.

The book states that she had brought expensive gold jewellery from Khaybar and presented it to the other wives. She particularly loved Fātimah (RA), the beloved daughter of the Prophet ﷺ, and gave her gold earrings as a gift.

She also tried to develop a close relationship with Aishah (RA) and Hafsah (RA), recognising the Prophet's ﷺ great love and esteem for them.

On one occasion, she told the Prophet ﷺ that she had heard that Hafsah (RA) had taunted her by calling her the daughter of a Jew. The Prophet ﷺ reminded Safiyyah (RA) of the honour she possessed: her husband was Muhammad ﷺ, her father was Hārūn (AS), and her uncle was Mūsā (AS).

The book also records an occasion when Aishah (RA) spoke disparagingly about Safiyyah (RA). The Prophet ﷺ warned her about the seriousness of such words.

The Incident During I'tikāf

An incident concerning Safiyyah (RA) is mentioned in **Sahih Al-Bukhari**.

During the last ten days of Ramadan, while the Prophet ﷺ was performing I'tikāf in the mosque, Safiyyah (RA) came to visit him.

When she later got up to leave, the Prophet ﷺ accompanied her outside. Two men from the Ansār saw him speaking with her and greeted him.

The Prophet ﷺ explained to them that the woman with him was his wife and that she had come to visit him.

They felt embarrassed that he had needed to explain himself. The Prophet ﷺ then taught them that Satan could create evil suspicions in people's hearts, and he did not want such suspicions to develop.

Her Love for the Qur'an

Safiyyah (RA) devoted a great deal of time to reading the Noble Qur'an.

The book describes the effect of the Qur'an upon her heart. Because of her fear of Allah, tears would flow down her cheeks and she would begin to sob while reflecting upon it.

When some Companions gathered in her apartment, they remembered Allah, recited the Qur'an and offered voluntary prayers. Safiyyah (RA) told them that all these acts were good, but they should also weep out of fear of Allah.

Her worship was therefore accompanied by a deep awareness of Allah and fear of Him.

Her Patience, Forgiveness and Kindness

Safiyyah (RA) is described as **extremely tolerant, patient, loving and kind-hearted**.

An incident recorded by Imam Dhahabi concerning one of her slave girls. The girl accused Safiyyah (RA) before Caliph Umar Farooq (RA), claiming that although Safiyyah had accepted Islam, she still observed the Jewish Sabbath and maintained good relations with Jews.

When Umar (RA) questioned Safiyyah (RA), she explained that after Allah had given the Muslims Friday and its blessings, she had stopped giving importance to Saturday. Regarding her relationship with the Jews, she explained that they were her relatives and that she was following the teachings of Allah and His Messenger to maintain good relations with one's kindred.

Later, Safiyyah (RA) discovered that it was her own slave girl who had made these accusations. When the girl admitted what she had done, Safiyyah (RA) **set her free**.

The book connects this action with the Qur'anic teaching:

> “Who repress anger, and who pardon men; verily, Allah loves the good-doers.” (3:134)

Her Knowledge and Final Years

Safiyyah (RA) was extremely knowledgeable and spent much of her time reciting the Noble Qur'an. The book states that she knew many more of its Surahs by heart.

After a full life, Safiyyah (RA) passed away in the **50th year after Hijrah**, during the caliphate of Mu'awiyah (RA), and was buried in **Jannatul Baqi'**.

She left **one hundred thousand dirhams**, which were distributed according to her will.

Her life, as presented in this chapter, reflects noble birth joined with faith, patience, forgiveness, devotion to the Qur'an and kindness towards others.

Source

Great Women of Islam, chapter: **“Safiyyah bint Huyayee”**, from the uploaded PDF.

Zainab Bint khazeemah

Zaynab bint Khuzaymah (RA): The Mother of the Poor and Needy

Introduction

Zaynab bint Khuzaymah (RA) was one of the wives of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ. She was well known for her generosity and kindness towards the poor and needy. Even before Islam, she was known as **“Ummul Masakeen” — the Mother of the Poor and Needy**, because of her habit of helping and feeding those in need.

Early Life and Charity

Zaynab (RA) was born about **thirteen years before the Prophet ﷺ was chosen as the Messenger of Allah**. She was among the early Muslims.

Her generosity was well known even before Islam. She helped the distressed and needy, and poets praised her for her charitable nature. The book also mentions the observations of **Ibn Katheer** and **Qastalani** concerning her reputation for charity.

Widowhood and Marriage to the Prophet ﷺ

Zaynab (RA) was married to **‘Abdullah bin Jahsh (RA)**, who was martyred during the Battle of Uhud. After his death, she devoted herself to prayer and worship.

The Prophet ﷺ later married her with a dowry of **four hundred dirhams**. An apartment was prepared for her near the apartments of Hafsah (RA) and Aishah (RA).

The book quotes the verse:

> “Allah wishes only to remove evil deed from you, O member of the family (of the Prophet), and to purify you with a thorough purification.”
> **(Surah Al-Ahzab, 33:33)**

Her Kindness and Sisterhood

Aishah (RA) and Hafsah (RA), who were already part of the household, treated Zaynab (RA) with sympathy and companionship. Her charitable nature became even stronger after she accepted Islam.

A Short Life

Zaynab (RA) lived in the household of the Prophet ﷺ for only about **eight months** before she passed away. She was **thirty years old**.

The Prophet ﷺ led her funeral prayer, and she was buried in **Jannatul Baqi‘**.

She was the **second wife of the Prophet ﷺ to die during his lifetime**, after Khadijah (RA).

Her Legacy

Zaynab (RA) is remembered in the book for her **generosity, charity, devotion and care for the poor and needy**. Her famous title, **Ummul Masakeen**, reflects the quality for which she was best known.

Sources

Great Women of Islam, pp. **73–75**.
The Noble Qur'an: Surah Al-Ahzab 33:33.
Hadith: The statement of the Prophet ﷺ about being commanded to marry women of Paradise.

Sawdah (RA)

— Saudah bint Zam‘ah (RA): Devotion and Generosity

Introduction

Saudah bint Zam‘ah (RA) was the **first lady to enter the household of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ after Khadijah (RA)**. The book describes her as **obedient, generous and loyal**, with a simple and selfless nature. She was among the first women to accept Islam and had the distinction of migrating twice.

Family and Early Life

Her mother was **Shammoos**, from Banu Najjar, a branch of the Quraysh, and her father was from Banu ‘Amr. Saudah (RA) was married to her cousin **Sakran bin ‘Amr**. Both husband and wife accepted Islam in its earliest days.

They migrated to **Abyssinia** with the second group of migrants. After spending a considerable period there, they returned to Makkah and later migrated to **Al-Madinah**.

Marriage to the Prophet ﷺ

After the death of Sakran bin ‘Amr, **Khawlah bint Hakim** suggested Saudah (RA) to the Prophet ﷺ. Khawlah then approached her husband, ‘Uthman bin Madh‘oon, and later spoke to the Prophet ﷺ about Saudah.

The proposal was accepted. The book states that **Zam‘ah bint Jahsh performed the Nikah**, and the Prophet ﷺ gave Saudah (RA) a **Mahr of 400 dirhams**.

Her Loving and Simple Nature

Saudah (RA) was known for her simple, selfless character. When **Ruqayyah (RA)** returned from Abyssinia after a long separation, Saudah warmly welcomed her.

She also had a light-hearted side. When she heard the Prophet ﷺ speaking about the **Dajjāl**, she became frightened and hid in a dark room. When she learned that the other wives had been joking with her, she came out and laughed at the incident.

Her Selflessness

When Saudah (RA) became old, she feared that the Prophet ﷺ might divorce her. She therefore offered her turn to **Aishah (RA)**.

The book connects this incident with the revelation of **Surah An-Nisa 4:128**:

> “And if a woman fears cruelty or desertion on her husband’s part, there is no sin on them both if they make terms of peace between themselves…”

Aishah (RA) was deeply moved by Saudah’s selflessness and sincerity.

Her Generosity and Character

Saudah (RA) was tall, healthy and known for her generosity. She was also described as having a sense of humour and enjoying light-hearted moments with the Prophet ﷺ and the other Mothers of the Believers.

During the caliphate of **‘Umar bin Khattab (RA)**, he sent her a bag of **Dirhams**. She distributed the money among the **poor and needy**.

Her Later Life

After the Prophet ﷺ passed away, Saudah (RA) remained in her home in Al-Madinah. The book states that she and **Zainab bint Jahsh (RA)** did not travel after his death, explaining that they had already performed Hajj and ‘Umrah in the company of the Prophet ﷺ and followed the command:

> “And stay in your homes.”
> **(Surah Al-Ahzab, 33:33)**

Her Hadith and Death

According to the book, **five authentic Ahadith** are attributed to Saudah (RA). Among them are narrations concerning the use of the skin of an animal after its death and performing Hajj on behalf of an elderly or infirm parent.

Saudah (RA) lived to an old age and passed away during the **caliphate of ‘Umar bin Khattab (RA)** at about the age of **eighty**. She was buried in **Jannatul-Baqi‘**.

Her Legacy

The life of Saudah bint Zam‘ah (RA), as presented in *Great Women of Islam*, reflects **faith, simplicity, loyalty, selflessness and generosity**. Her care for others and willingness to give up her own turn for Aishah (RA) are among the qualities highlighted in her biography.

Sources

Great Women of Islam: Who Were Given the Good News of Paradise by Mahmood Ahmad Ghadanfar, chapter **“Saudah bint Zam‘ah”**, pp. **33–39**.

The Noble Qur’an:
Surah An-Nisa (4:128)
Surah Al-Ahzab (33:33)
Surah Al-Fajr (89:27–30)

Maimoonah (RA)

Maimoonah bint Al-Harith (RA): A Legacy of Kinship and Faith

Introduction

Maimoonah bint Al-Harith (RA) was the **last lady married by the Prophet Muhammad** ﷺ. Her original name was **Barah**, which the Prophet ﷺ changed to Maimoonah. She was known for her piety and for maintaining the ties of kinship. Aishah (RA) praised her after her death as a woman who was highly God-fearing and maintained family relationships.

Her Family and Early Life

Maimoonah (RA) was the daughter of **Hārith bin Hazan** of Banu Hilāl, and her mother was **Hind bint ‘Auf**. She belonged to a distinguished family.

Before marrying the Prophet ﷺ, she was married first to **Mas‘ood bin ‘Amr bin ‘Omair Thaqafi**, but they separated because of incompatibility. Her second husband was **Abu Raham bin ‘Abdul ‘Uzzā**, who passed away shortly after their marriage.

Her Marriage to the Prophet ﷺ

In the seventh year after Hijrah, the Prophet ﷺ travelled to Makkah to perform the compensatory ‘Umrah. Maimoonah (RA) wished to marry him and this proposal was conveyed through her family.

After completing his three-day stay in Makkah, the Prophet ﷺ left and **pitched his camp at Saraf, about nine miles from Makkah**, where the marriage was celebrated. Maimoonah (RA) was **twenty-six years old** at the time.

Her Life in Al-Madinah

After arriving in Al-Madinah, an apartment was prepared for Maimoonah (RA) near the Prophet’s ﷺ mosque. She spent much of her time in prayer.

She was also attentive to family relationships. On one occasion, when her nephew Ziyad bin ‘Abdullah visited her, she immediately explained his relationship to the Prophet ﷺ when she noticed his displeasure at seeing an unfamiliar man.

Her Knowledge and Narrations

Maimoonah (RA) narrated **seventy-six Ahadith**. Among the narrations mentioned in the book are those concerning a mouse falling into clarified butter, a puppy in the Prophet’s ﷺ house, and borrowing money with trust in Allah's help to repay it.

Her Final Days

The Prophet's ﷺ final illness began in Maimoonah's apartment. His wives later agreed that he should spend his remaining days in Aishah's (RA) apartment.

Maimoonah (RA) died in **51 AH**. Her relatives took her to **Saraf**, the place where her marriage had been celebrated, and she passed away there. **'Abdullah bin 'Abbas (RA)** led her funeral prayer, and she was buried there.

Her Legacy

Maimoonah (RA) is remembered in the book for her **piety, family ties, devotion and contribution to preserving Prophetic teachings**.

Source

Great Women of Islam by Mahmood Ahmad Ghadanfar, pp. **137–141**.